



Northstar Analytics Benefits Eligibility and Enrollment Procedure

Eligibility review enrollment changes and benefit record administration

Procedure owner	People Operations	Version	1.0
Effective date	September 26 2026	Applies to	Benefits eligible employees

1 Purpose and Scope

This procedure explains how Northstar Analytics determines benefit eligibility, communicates available plans, enrolls eligible employees and dependents, processes permitted changes, and maintains benefit records. It applies to employees offered company-sponsored benefits and to dependents enrolled under applicable plan terms.

Official plan documents, insurance contracts, carrier rules, and applicable law control if they conflict with this procedure. Northstar may amend or discontinue benefits as permitted by law. Participation is not a guarantee of continued employment, a particular benefit, or a specific level of coverage.

2 Roles and Responsibilities

- **Employees.** Review notices, make elections on time, provide accurate information, verify deductions, and report changes promptly.
- **People Operations.** Confirms eligibility, provides enrollment materials, reviews supporting records, submits elections, and coordinates corrections.
- **Payroll.** Applies authorized deductions and taxable benefit treatment and reports discrepancies to People Operations.
- **Plan administrators and carriers.** Administer coverage, claims, eligibility feeds, and required notices under governing plan terms.

3 Eligibility Determination

Eligibility is based on the employee's classification, scheduled work hours, work location, hire or rehire date, and the terms of each benefit plan. People Operations records the eligibility determination and provides the employee with the applicable benefit summary, cost information, enrollment deadline, and instructions.

Temporary workers, independent contractors, interns, and employees below a plan's hours or classification threshold are not eligible unless a plan document or applicable law states otherwise. Eligibility for one benefit does not automatically establish eligibility for another.

4 Eligible Dependents

A spouse, domestic partner, child, or other dependent may be enrolled only when permitted by the applicable plan and law. The employee must provide complete identifying information and any requested proof of relationship or dependent status. Employees must notify People Operations when a dependent no longer qualifies.

5 New Hire and Rehire Enrollment

- **Notice.** People Operations sends enrollment materials and the election deadline after eligibility is confirmed.
- **Review.** The employee compares plan options, coverage levels, costs, exclusions, provider networks, and required documents.
- **Election.** The employee submits elections or waivers through the designated portal or form before the stated deadline.
- **Confirmation.** People Operations or the system provides confirmation; the employee must review it and promptly report errors.

6 Enrollment Deadlines and Default Treatment

Enrollment deadlines are stated in the employee's notice and reflect plan and legal requirements. If an employee does not submit a complete election by the deadline, the employee will receive only any company-paid default coverage identified in the plan materials and will be treated as declining optional coverage, unless correction is permitted by the plan or law.

People Operations may request missing information, but a request does not extend the deadline unless confirmed in writing. Employees who waive coverage should retain confirmation of the waiver and any information required for future special enrollment rights.

7 Annual Open Enrollment

During annual open enrollment, eligible employees may review available plans, contribution rates, and coverage changes for the next plan year. Employees must complete any required active election, dependent re-verification, or waiver by the announced deadline. Elections generally remain in effect for the plan year unless a permitted midyear change applies.

8 Qualified Life Events and Special Enrollment

Outside open enrollment, changes are allowed only when permitted by the plan and applicable law. Examples may include marriage, divorce, birth, adoption, loss or gain of other coverage, a dependent's eligibility change, or another recognized status change. The requested election must be consistent with the event.

- **Report the event.** Contact People Operations as soon as possible and within the deadline stated in plan or legal notices.
- **Submit documentation.** Provide the event date, requested change, and required proof, such as a marriage certificate, birth record, or loss-of-coverage notice.
- **Review and confirmation.** People Operations determines whether the request is permitted and confirms the effective date or explains why it cannot be processed.

9 Coverage Effective Dates

Coverage begins, changes, or ends on the date established by the governing plan, carrier, and applicable law. The date may depend on timely enrollment, completion of required documentation, waiting periods, or the qualifying event. Employees should not assume coverage is active until they receive confirmation and should verify identification cards and provider records when applicable.

10 Payroll Deductions and Employee Review

Employee contributions are deducted from pay as authorized and may be taken before or after tax depending on the benefit and law. The employee must review the first affected pay statement and later statements after any change. Questions about a deduction or missing deduction must be reported promptly; delayed reporting can affect the timing or availability of corrections.

11 Leave Status and Employment Changes

A leave of absence, reduction in hours, transfer, change in work location, return from leave, or separation from employment may affect eligibility, contributions, or coverage. People Operations will provide applicable continuation, conversion, portability, payment, or termination information. Employees remain responsible for premiums or other amounts due under the plan and leave terms.

12 Corrections Appeals and Unresolved Issues

Employees should send suspected enrollment or deduction errors to People Operations with the election confirmation, relevant dates, and supporting records. Northstar will review the record and coordinate with Payroll, the plan administrator, or carrier. Corrections are subject to plan terms, carrier approval, tax rules, and law and may not be available retroactively.

Benefit claim denials and eligibility appeals must follow the procedure and deadline in the applicable plan document or denial notice. People Operations can identify the appropriate administrator but does not decide carrier or plan fiduciary appeals unless designated to do so.

13 Privacy and Recordkeeping

Benefit information must be handled as confidential personnel information. Employees should use approved systems and secure transmission methods and should not send sensitive medical, identity, or dependent records through unapproved channels. Northstar retains enrollment records and access logs according to its retention schedule, plan requirements, and applicable law.

14 Enrollment Workflow

Step	Required action
1 Confirm	People Operations determines eligibility and issues plan materials, costs, instructions, and deadlines.
2 Review	Employee evaluates options and gathers dependent or life-event documentation.
3 Elect	Employee submits complete elections or waivers through the approved method by the deadline.
4 Validate	People Operations reviews submissions and sends eligible elections to Payroll and plan administrators.
5 Verify	Employee checks confirmation, coverage records, and payroll deductions and reports errors promptly.

15 Exceptions and Related Documents

People Operations may approve an administrative correction or exception only when allowed by the governing plan and law. Managers may not promise coverage, waive enrollment deadlines, or authorize benefit changes. Suspected falsification or intentional misuse may result in loss of coverage, repayment obligations, corrective action, or referral to the plan administrator or authorities.

Related documents include the Employee Handbook; Paid Time Off Policy; Leave of Absence Procedure; Payroll Administration Procedure; Data Classification and Handling Standard; Information Security and Acceptable Use Policy; and applicable summary plan descriptions, benefit summaries, and required notices.